Preface

Throughout the course of this book, you'll learn how to apply a test-driven development (TDD) process to the creation of applications that use Ruby and Rails. I'll talk about how to apply TDD to your daily coding and about the tools and libraries that make testing in Rails easier.

The goal is to show you how to apply a test-driven process and automated testing as you build a Rails application. Being test-driven allows you to use testing to explore your code's design. You'll see what tools are available and learn when those tools are best used. Tools come and tools go, so I'm really hoping you come away from this book committed to the idea of writing better code through the small steps of a test-driven development process.

Who You Are

I'm assuming some things about you.

I'm assuming you're already comfortable with Ruby and Rails and that you don't need this book to explain how to get started creating a Rails application in and of itself. I'm *not* assuming you have any particular familiarity with testing frameworks or testing tools used within Rails.

Over the course of this book, I'll go through the tools that are available for writing tests, and I'll talk about them with an eye toward making them useful in building your application. This is Rails, so naturally I have my own opinions, but the goal with all the tools and all the advice is the same: to help you write great applications that do cool things and still catch the train home.

What's in This Book

We'll start with an introduction to test-driven development in general: what it is, why it works, and when to use it. In the next two chapters we'll walk through a tutorial using RSpec to create tests for a new Rails application. You'll start testing without using Rails-specific features, and then you'll start